

```

    <age>
      12
    </age>
    <birthday>
      11-08-1958
    </birthday>
    <address>
      34, Someplace, Some lane, Some City,
Some State, Some country
    </address>
    <email>
      abc@xyz.com
    </email>
    <private>
      1
    </private>
  </contact>
</addressbook>

```

The additional information here is merely:

Tag Jones; 12; 11-08-1958; 34, Someplace, Some lane, Some City, Some State, Some country; abc@xyz.com; 1

The data is a mere 101 characters compared to the XML version, which is 247 characters – an efficiency of 41 per cent! The most inefficiently stored data is the age field, which is usually just two characters; and the private flag, which is a single character. The efficiency further reduces if the data has a lot of flags i.e. YES / NO options.

We could accomplish the same thing we have done with the above XML in a much more efficient manner by rewriting it as follows:

```

  <a>
    <c>
      <n>Tag Jones</n>
      <g>12</g>
      <b>11-08-1958</b>
      <d>
        34, Someplace, Some lane, Some City, Some
State, Some country

```